



Building knowledge together

THE MIRROR JET 2 EXAMS 2025

Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education

PRE MOCK EXAMINATION 2025



Building knowledge together

101/2

ENGLISH

PAPER 2

JUNE, 2025

TIME: 2 Hrs. 30Mins

Name: Adm No: Index No..... Strm.....

School: Signature:

101/2 - ENGLISH

Monday, 9/06/2025

11.00-1.30pm

101/2

ENGLISH PAPER 2

(Comprehension, literary Appreciation and Grammar)

Time: 2 ½ hours

Instructions

- (a) Write your name, index number in the spaces provided above this paper.
- (b) All questions in this paper are compulsory.
- (c) Answer **ALL** questions in the spaces provided.

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Question	Maximum Score	Candidate's Score
1	20	
2	25	
3	20	
4	15	
TOTAL	80	

This paper consists of 10 printed pages. Students should check the question paper to ensure that all pages are printed as indicated and that no questions are missing.

1. Read the passage below and then answer the questions that follow:

For Africans living abroad, nothing is more irritating than the constant diet of negative news on Africa. The only silver lining is that Africa is way down the list of news importance for the Western media. Most of the time Africa is ignored but when it does make it into the newspapers, radio or TV, then it is always portrayed as sinking in corruption, wars, famine and disease. If you set out to find a positive story on Africa, you may have to wait until your grandchildren have grown old.

What is more unfortunate is that whereas the rest of the world is divided into nations, Africa is lumped into one big sorry mass. A civil war in a tiny country in Africa elicits screaming headlines such as “Africa returns to barbarity”. Civil wars in Europe are not European civil wars but civil wars in Bosnia, Serbia and so on. No one bothers to mention that out of Africa’s 54 countries, only two may be engaged in civil wars. That means 52 countries are peaceful. But the impression you get from the Western media is that all of Africa is at war with itself.

The same goes for diseases, especially AIDS. Hardly does a week go by without the ‘experts’ from the West predicting how Africa’s entire population will be wiped out in fifty years’ time. If all the predictions made about the impact of AIDS had been correct, most African countries would have been entirely depopulated by now.

According to the Western media, Africa is corrupt, all the time. It is interesting to note that in America, for example, only the executives of a given company are said to be corrupt while all African leaders are seen as being irredeemably corrupt.

The point being put across is that Africa is guilty unless proven innocent. Western journalists assigned to cover Africa are in most cases the most junior and the least experienced in the organization. They are given this version of a ‘Hopeless Continent’ for so long that when they land in any African country, they immediately set out to confirm their prejudices. And you can always find what you are looking for.

The situation is similar to the search for weapons of mass destruction in Iraq. In Africa, Western journalists set out to find corruption, decay and mismanagement. And if they cannot find it, they will invent it on the basis that ‘it must be there somewhere.’

The cause of this generalized negative view of Africa is complex. When you confront Western journalists, they deny that their view of Africa is prejudiced. They are probably telling the truth because they report what they see – but they see what they want to see. And what they want to see subconsciously is a version of backward, primitive and uncivilized Africa.

So, while we feel irritated and even angered by the Western media’s portrayal of Africa, we must remember that many journalists cannot help but see Africa the way they are programmed to do. The only way this can change is if the programming is changed. But how do you go about doing so? The first step is to create space for dialogue between the Western media and Africans, it is during such discussions that Africans will be able to tell their side of the story. If this happens, then the Western media will see Africa as we do – a glorious continent full of promise but going through a rough time at present.

a) What is the likelihood of finding a positive story on Africa? (2 marks)

b) Why are Bosnia and Serbia mentioned? (2 marks)

c) Why is the word 'experts' in the third paragraph put within quotation marks? (2 marks)

d) Rewrite the following sentence to begin: Had ...

"If all the predictions made about the impact of AIDS had been correct, most countries would have been entirely depopulated."

(1 mark)

e) According to the passage, is Africa more corrupt than America? Explain your answer. (3 marks)

f) Give two reasons why African stories are mainly assigned to the most junior and inexperienced journalists. (4 marks)

g) How can we tell that the author of this story is an African? (2 marks)

h) Explain the meaning of the following expressions as used in the passage. (3 marks)

i) silver lining _____

ii) sorry _____

iii) irredeemably _____

2. Read the following excerpt and then answer the questions that follow:

Nicole: (*Startled and still standing by the doorway*) My sincere apologies, Madam Principal... I have not...

Narine: (*Cutting her short*) Look at me if you ever see! Do I look like your house girl? Or your Secretary?

Nicole: (*Calmly*) You certainly are not, Madam Principal, but please...

Narine: (*Interrupting Nicole again*) You think I was employed here to be receiving phone calls from Municipal leaders informing me that they are coming to see you?

Nicole: It is not my choice that this is happening.

Narine: Now listen, they are coming here to see you!

Nicole: Who is coming?

Narine: All of them! Including that Inspector of Police who took you to the cells! Did you ever care to know what battles I am fighting to ensure your safety and defend the school's position? I am now being threatened and I am fed up! Did you think that I was employed to be a **firefighter**?

Nicole: My apologies, Madam...

Narine: (*Interrupting Nicole*) Now there is nothing that will be happening in this school except receiving Municipal leaders coming to see you! And I will never think about anything else beyond the safety of a young ambitious girl who has no idea what danger she is putting herself into! You think that is fair to me? To the students? To the school? Do you think the life of the school is all about the App? Okay then... go ahead... go on and upload us all into that App!

Nicole: What should I do, Madam Principal?

Narine: I told you to think of something! You need to think. The App will not change anything. The struggle for good governance stretches as far back as the beginning of human history. And after all those years the management of public affairs is much worse today than it has ever been. Our forefathers were slaves to white people. Today we have been enslaved by our very own people!

Nicole: What can I do, Madam Principal?

Narine: I have said it several times that the bamboo that bends is stronger than the oak that resists, and if you can't turn the wind, turn the sail!

Nicole: What do you mean, Madam Principal? You prefer we resign ourselves to slavery? Would you rather we let the **plunder** of public resources continue unchallenged?

Narine: Don't give me a headache young girl! They are all coming! You will discuss with them what you prefer! Personally what I know is that I have a duty to the students under my charge. And if you don't think of a way out of this, I will have no choice but to personally grab you by your pants

and **hound** you out of my vicinity through the neatest available opening! Now do you understand? *(Pauses to listen. Heavy footsteps can be heard approaching along the corridor.)* That must be them. And I promise you, I will not sit in that meeting, it is not part of my mandate!

Questions

a) What allegation is Nicole responding to at the start of the excerpt? (1 mark)

b) From your knowledge of the text, mention any two strategies that the Mayor and his team uses when they finally engage Nicole to try and persuade her to drop the idea of the Samaritan App. For each strategy, state her response. (4 marks)

c) Explain Nicole's dilemma in this excerpt. (2 marks)

d) Discuss any two thematic concerns address in the excerpt above. (4 marks)

e) Discuss how Narine is portrayed in the excerpt above. (4 marks)

f) Show the effectiveness any two aspects of style used in the excerpt.

(4 marks)

g) From Narine's last speech in the excerpt, what would you say is her attitude towards Nicole? (3 marks)

h) Explain the meaning of the following words as used in the excerpt.

(3 marks)

i) firefighter _____

ii) plunder _____

iii) hound you out of my vicinity _____

3. Read the following oral poem and then answer the questions that follow:

Christine Vakhoya

Who commanded when you go on a journey
You don't tell your friend?
Who is this witch who commanded
When you go on a journey you stealthily crawl
Like a worm and go,
Or like sugar ants
Hiding in sugarcane plantations?

Christine!
Vakhoya!
We are shocked.

Christine the journey you went,
Has left our hearts bleeding.

We have planted maize,
It has refused to grow,
We have tried to clear the bushes,
They have refused to get cut.

Christine!
What was this fate?

Christine!
The journey!
Oh – No!

Christine the journey you went
Has left our hearts bleeding,
Mark you blood not water.

Oh! Mother's daughter!
Oh! Mother's cook!
Oh! The loved one,
What shall I do poor mother's cook
Christine!

Christin the journey you went,
Oh we are sad,
It is a difficult journey,
We know each individual will have to go,
We do not know the day.

(L.O. Abukutsa)

a) Who is the likely singer of this item? Why?

(2 marks)

b) With a reason, classify the above oral poem.

(2 marks)

c) Identify and illustrate three features of oral poems evident in the above item. (6 marks)

d) Describe the mood of the oral poem. (3 marks)

e) Account for how the 'journey' Christine has taken has affected the persona psychologically. (1 mark)

f) Why do you think the singer refers to Christine as 'Mothers daughter'? (2 marks)

g) Explain any function of the oral item. (2 marks)

h) Explain the meaning of the following lines used in the oral poem. (2 marks)

i) When you go on a journey

ii) Has left our hearts bleeding.

4. a) Rewrite the following sentences according to the instructions given after each. Do not change the meaning. (5 marks)

i) All the students performed well in the last exam. (Begin: Not ...)

ii) I enjoyed the man said a plate of mokimo at the restaurant. (Punctuate well)

iii) Most students have started improving. This should be appreciated by all. (Begin: That ...)

iv) Because the players were ill prepared for the game, they conceded many goals. (Begin: But ...)

v) I know that one of your books has been published. (Begin: I know that a ...)

b) Complete the following sentences using an appropriate preposition. (3 marks)

i) The two strangers were found guilty _____ the offence and charged _____ murder.

ii) I arrived at the airport just _____ time to catch the airplane.

iii) He divided _____ the sea and swam.

c) Use the correct form of the word in brackets to fill in the blanks. (4 marks)

i) The growing _____ between Kenya and Tanzania should not be allowed to grow out of hand. (enemy)

ii) The _____ which he advanced did not hold.

iii) I wonder why he had _____ that particular song when the president visited Homabay. (sing)

iv) These _____ phones should be confiscated. (student)

d) Supply appropriate question tags to the following sentences.

(2 marks)

i) Let the sleeping dogs lie.

ii) They have a lot pf money.

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